

Build Steps

Part 1 of 5 — Set up the agent, orchestration, and knowledge

1 Create Your Copilot Studio Agent

Open Copilot Studio (copilotstudio.microsoft.com), select Create → New agent, then configure:

Agent Name	Public Sector Case Triage Copilot
Description	Triages incoming citizen and member requests across housing, benefits, permits, complaints and information — categorises, prioritises by SLA, and drafts plain-language acknowledgement letters.
Solution / Environment	Public Sector Operations · Default environment
Icon	Use a recognisable colour and emoji or upload a brand icon

2 Choose Orchestration Mode

Under Settings → Generative AI, choose how the agent decides what to do:

Generative Orchestration

Recommended — AI-led

- Agent reasons over user input and picks the right topic, tool, or knowledge
- Handles paraphrases, multi-step asks, and follow-ups naturally
- Best for varied user intent and exploratory questions
- Requires clear instructions, tool descriptions, and good knowledge

Classic Orchestration

Deterministic — trigger-led

- Topics fire on explicit trigger phrases you author
- Predictable flows, easier to audit step-by-step
- Best for tightly-scoped, regulated, or compliance-critical journeys
- Less forgiving of phrasing the author didn't anticipate

For this build we use Generative Orchestration so the agent can blend knowledge lookups with tool calls for citizen case triage and SLA management.

3 Add Knowledge

Go to the Knowledge tab → Add knowledge → File, then upload PublicSector_Cases_Data.xlsx. This file contains:

- Case metadata (case ID, category — Housing / Benefits / Permits / Complaints / Info)
- Lifecycle (submitted date, SLA days, days open, status — New / In progress / Resolved / Closed)
- Priority and channel (Low / Med / High; Web / Phone / Walk-in / Post)
- Citizen context (citizen reference code, assigned officer, summary)

You can layer additional sources later — SharePoint sites, Dataverse, public web, or Graph connectors.

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Part 2 of 5 — Add instructions and a custom topic

4 Add Agent Instructions

Open Overview → Instructions and paste the following (these guide the model regardless of orchestration mode):

You are the Public Sector Case Triage Copilot. You help two audiences:

- 1) Front-line case officers triaging the queue.
- 2) Service managers monitoring SLA risk and channel mix.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded cases dataset as your single source of truth.
- Write in plain language at roughly an 8th-grade reading level.
- Be accessibility-aware: short sentences, no jargon, no Latin abbreviations.
- For acknowledgement letters, call the 'Create Acknowledgement Letter' tool.
- For SLA risk, surface cases where DaysOpen approaches or exceeds SLA_Days.
- Treat citizen references as confidential – never expose another citizen's case to an unrelated officer or channel.

5 Add a Custom Topic

Go to Topics → Add a topic → Create from description. Topics are reusable conversation flows the agent can call when intent matches.

Topic name: Triage New Case

Description: Walks a case officer through categorising and prioritising a new citizen request, picks the right SLA, and offers to draft an acknowledgement letter for the citizen.

Trigger phrases (Generative Orchestration uses these as intent hints, Classic mode uses them as exact triggers):

- Triage a new case
- Help me categorise this request
- What's the SLA for this
- Acknowledge the new request from CIT-7821

Conversation steps:

- Ask for: citizen reference (optional), channel, free-text summary
- Suggest a Category from {Housing, Benefits, Permits, Complaints, Info}
- Suggest Priority from {Low, Med, High} based on summary keywords
- Calculate target SLA in days from category and priority (cite the rule)
- Read the suggestion back to the officer and ask to confirm or override
- Call 'Create Acknowledgement Letter' tool with the confirmed category and SLA

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Part 3 of 5 — Add a tool and configure settings

6 Add a Tool

Tools let the agent take an action, not just answer. Go to Tools → Add a tool, and choose one of:

- Prebuilt connector (Outlook, Teams, SharePoint, Dataverse, ServiceNow, etc.)
- Power Automate cloud flow (custom logic you author or already own)
- Custom HTTP request (any REST API your agent can reach)
- Model Context Protocol (MCP) server — for richer tool ecosystems

Tool name: Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word

Type: Word for the web connector (Create document from template) + SharePoint save

Description: Creates a plain-language acknowledgement letter draft from the approved Word template, populated with citizen reference, category, SLA, and the assigned officer name.

Inputs the agent will collect or infer:

- Citizen reference code (string)
- Category (Housing / Benefits / Permits / Complaints / Info)
- SLA in days (number)
- Assigned officer (from authenticated user)
- Optional personalisation note (string)

Outcome: Returns the SharePoint URL of the draft letter and posts an approval card to the case officer's team channel for review before send.

7 Configure Settings

Open the Settings cog (top right). Configure these four areas before you let real users near the agent:

- General — confirm name, description, and primary language
- Generative AI — orchestration mode and content moderation level (start at Medium)
- Authentication — use 'Authenticate with Microsoft' so the agent runs as the signed-in user
- Security — review DLP policy, enabled channels, and end-user authentication

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Part 4 of 5 — Evaluate, test, and publish to a channel

8 Evaluate Your Agent

Go to Analytics → Evaluations → New evaluation. Build a test set so you can measure quality before and after every change.

Test set name: Public Sector Case Triage – Baseline v1
Approach: Pair each input prompt with an expected outcome.
Run the evaluation and review three scores per response:

- Groundedness – did the answer stay inside the knowledge?
- Relevance – did it actually address the question?
- Accuracy – did it match the expected outcome?

Sample evaluation items:

Input: Show all High priority cases breaching SLA today

Expect: Filters Priority=High AND DaysOpen >= SLA_Days; lists with citizen reference codes.

Input: How many cases came in via Walk-in last week by category?

Expect: Filters Channel=Walk-in within 7 days, groups by Category, returns counts.

Input: Draft an acknowledgement letter for CIT-7821, housing repair request

Expect: Triggers Triage New Case topic and calls Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word.

9 Test in the Test Pane

Use the Test pane (right side of the canvas) while you build. For each query, click Activity map to inspect what the agent did:

- Which topic, tool, or knowledge source fired (and in what order)
- Inputs the agent collected and outputs the tool returned
- Citations linking each answer back to a row of your knowledge file
- Latency per step — useful when tuning multi-tool flows

10 Publish to a Channel

When you're happy, click Publish (top right). Then open Channels and enable the surface your users live in. Recommended for this build: Custom Demo website — many front-line officers don't have Teams licences.

- Custom website (Demo / intranet) — primary surface for front-line officers
- Microsoft Teams — for service managers and supervisors reviewing SLA risk
- Microsoft 365 Copilot — for back-office and policy teams
- Telephony (Azure Communication Services) — capture phone-channel cases directly

Teams and M365 Copilot channels require tenant admin approval before users see the agent — plan for that lead time.

Try These Live

Part 5 of 5 — Sample queries to test your agent during the build-along.

Queue Triage

Show all High priority cases currently breaching SLA.
Which categories have the most New cases this week?

Plain-Language Drafting

Draft an acknowledgement letter for CIT-7821, housing repair request.
Rewrite this case summary in plain English for the citizen.

SLA & Channel Mix

What's the average days-to-resolve by category?
How many cases arrived via Walk-in last week?

How to Think About This Agent

This agent replaces:

- Manual queue categorisation
- Hand-written acknowledgement letters
- Spreadsheet SLA trackers refreshed nightly

With:

- ✓ Consistent triage decisions, audit-trailed
- ✓ Plain-language letters drafted in seconds
- ✓ SLA risk surfaced before it becomes a complaint

Trusted, governed, enterprise AI — built once, used everywhere.

Tip for real-world use

Publish to a custom website channel — many front-line officers don't have a Teams licence. Use accessibility checks on the Word template (alt text, reading order, language tags) so generated letters meet your accessibility standard from day one.

You've built a Copilot Studio agent ✓

You now have an AI agent that can:

- Triage and categorise new cases
- Draft plain-language letters
- Surface SLA risk before breach
- Standardise citizen experience